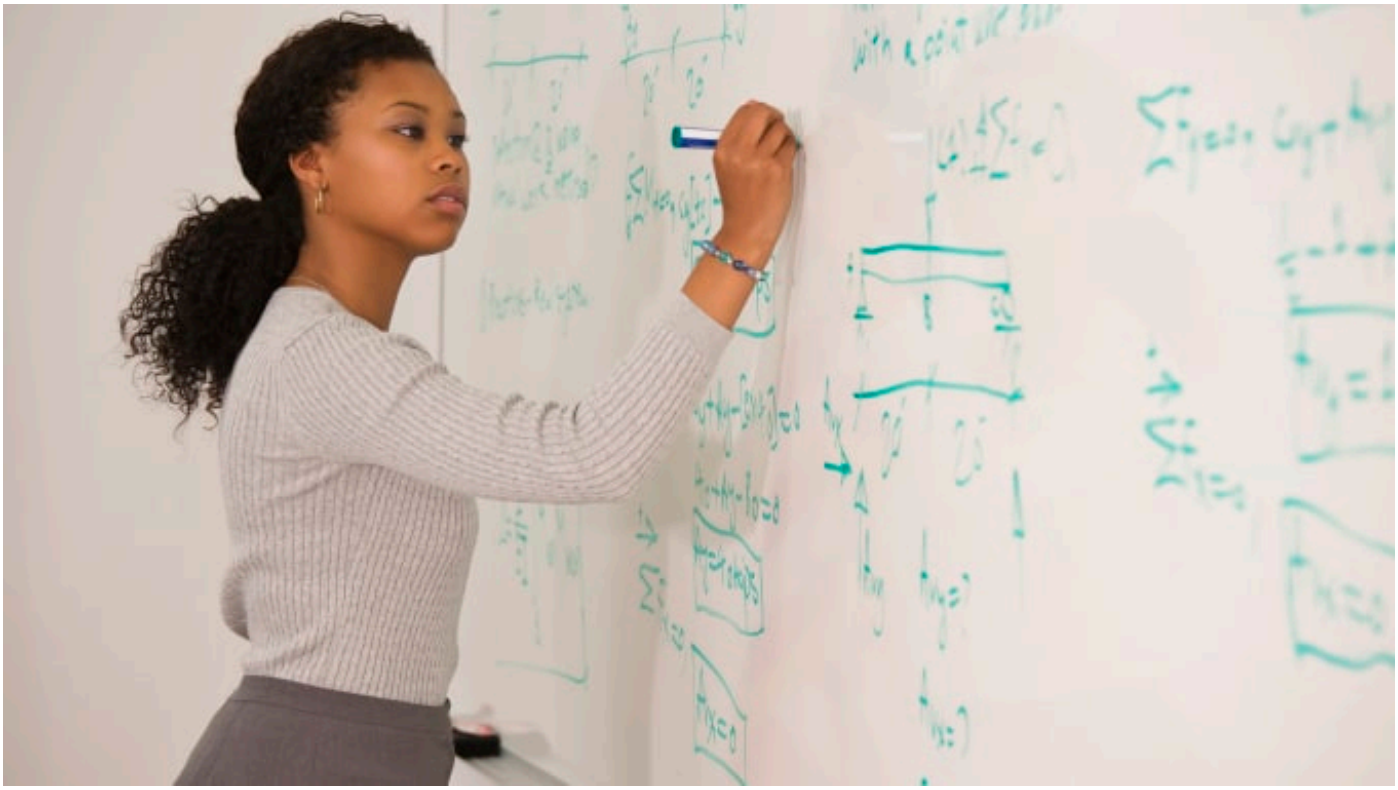
Here are the best and worst jobs of 2019

Published Tue, May 7 201910:31 AM EDT



Ariel Skelley/Getty Images

If you want a job in a growing field with high pay and low stress, you should probably like math, numbers and data.

Of the 10 best jobs for 2019 — based on income, anticipated growth rate, work environment and stress — five are in mathematical sciences, according to a new report released by CareerCast.com.

The ranking shows not only continued demand for workers with a STEM background — science, technology, engineering and mathematics — but also widespread need by companies for help sorting the massive amounts of data

they collect.

"STEM fields have pretty much consistently been at the top of these reports, but the numbers aspect is interesting because so many industries need those positions," said Kyle Kensing, online content editor at CareerCast.

Ranking	Profession	Annual median salary	Growth outlook (to 2026)
1	Data scientist	$118,370	19%
2	Statistician	$88,190	33%
3	University professor	$78,470	15%
4	Occupational therapist	$84,270	24%
5	Genetic counselor	$80,370	29%
6	Medical services manager	$99,730	20%
7	Information security analyst	$98,350	28%
8	Mathematician	$88,190	33%
9	Operations research analyst	$83,390	27%
10	Actuary	$102,880	22%

The annual report, released Tuesday, comes amid the strongest labor market in 50 years. With the unemployment rate at 3.6%, there are more job openings than there are people looking for work.

By comparison, 10 years ago in the midst of the Great Recession, there was one opening for every 6.2 unemployed job seekers, according to government data.

All of the top 10 positions on CareerCast's new ranking require at least a

bachelor's degree. The top-ranked job is data scientist, which comes with a median salary of $118,370 and a growth outlook of 19% from 2016 to 2026. Coming in second is statistician, which has a median $88,190 salary and is expected to grow at a 33% clip in that 10-year period.

At the bottom of the list

Ranking	Profession	Annual median salary	Growth outlook (to 2026)
211	Broadcaster	$66,880	0%
212	Advertising salesperson	$51,740	-4%
213	Nuclear decontamination technician	$42,030	17%
214	Disc jockey	$31,990	-9%
215	Correctional officer	$44,400	-7%
216	Enlisted military personnel	$26,802	n/a
217	Retail salesperson	$24,340	2%
218	Newspaper reporter	$43,490	-9%
219	Logging worker	$40,650	-13%
220	Taxi driver	$25,980	5%

"It's about our work being based online," Kensing said. "There's more data out there than ever before.

"Things like consumption habits, trends in the workplace, or in health care going from paper records to cloud-based data — all that data needs to be interpreted."

Rounding out the top five are university professor, occupational therapist and genetic counselor.

At the opposite end of the ranking are many jobs that are becoming less common, in part due to displacement from technology. Or, factors such as lower pay, stress or potential for danger can contribute to their low ranking.

At the very bottom is taxi driver, which comes with a median annual salary of $25,980 and anticipated growth in the field of just 5% to 2026.



"Before, even though it didn't pay well, it had good job growth," Kensing said. "Now that's fallen because of ride-sharing options."

Also at the bottom of the heap is logging. While the salary is $40,650, the growth outlook is a negative 13%. Newspaper reporters, with median pay of $43,490, also face a negative 9% growth rate.

Nevertheless, Kensing said, if you're interested in one of those jobs, its ranking shouldn't dissuade you.

"Just because it ranks near the bottom doesn't mean it's not a great job,"

Kensing said. "A lot of them are vital to our society.

"This just gives you an educated look at the challenges that come with them."

More from Personal Finance:

Young or old, it's a good time to get a job

Employers are hiring, but don't expect a bigger paycheck

Your kid's sports may be sabotaging your financial health

Subscribe to CNBC on YouTube.